

wagonmaker and a cook. Neither of his parents was musically literate, but an uncle was responsible for the music at a church in the nearby town of Hainburg. At the age of five, Haydn was sent to live in this relative's house and join in the church music-making. There he was spotted by the choirmaster from Vienna's St. Stephen's Cathedral and recruited to the cathedral choir. From the age of eight, he endured the casual ill-treatment—poor food, frequent flogging—visited upon 18th-century choristers, but picked up valuable practical musical experience.



ST. STEPHEN'S CATHEDRAL

Vienna's imposing cathedral, one of the city's most symbolic buildings, is where Joseph Haydn and his younger brother Michael served as choristers.